Tangkhul Clan System, Kinship & Social Order (Shangnao)

Anthropological Codification of Patrilineal Clans, Exogamy Rules, Chieftainship & Longshim

Tangkhul Language Library Digital Archive -- Cultural & Spiritual Heritage

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Part I: Sociological Framework & Major Patrilineal Clans (Shangnao)

Absence of caste hierarchy; egalitarian clan organization and exogamy rules:

SOCIOLOGICAL PRINCIPLES:

1. No Caste System: Tangkhul society is strictly non-caste, egalitarian and democratic.
2. Patrilineal Clans (Shang / Shangnao): Lineage identity passes unbroken down the male descent.
3. Strict Clan Exogamy: Intra-clan marriage is prohibited (Masi-kongra); unions unite separate clans.

THE MAJOR PATRILINEAL CLANS:

*** Shimray / Shimray-nao [Hunphun (Ukhrul), Chingjaroi, Paorei, Phungcham]**
Historic Role: One of the most ancient and prominent patrician lineages; historically provides hereditary chiefs (Awunga...
Insignia/Crest: Hornbill crest (Langva) and royal spear insignia.

*** Luikham [Hunphun, Nungbi, Tolloi, Ngaimu]**
Historic Role: Venerable agricultural and political lineage; historically entrusted with presiding over the inaugural so...
Insignia/Crest: Terraced sheaf motif and sacred bronze gong.

*** Kasomwoshi [Hunphun, Somdal, Huishu, Shirui]**
Historic Role: Celebrated custodians of philosophical jurisprudence, customary proverbs (Chanjam / Paotam), diplomatic a...
Insignia/Crest: Carved council post and wisdom staff.

*** Zimik [Northern Tangkhul (Raphei), Hunphun, Kharasom, Jessami borders]**
Historic Role: Prominent mountain lineage; renowned for high bravery, customary water irrigation covenants, and elder co...
Insignia/Crest: Mountain eagle and water spring symbol.

*** Vashum [Hunphun, Teinem, Somdal, Lambui]**
Historic Role: Celebrated lineage renowned for warrior prowess, defense strategy, master woodcraft, and hunting ceremoni...
Insignia/Crest: Crossed battle spears and wild boar tusks.

*** Shaiza [Hunphun (Ukhrul), Somdal, Choithar]**
Historic Role: Highly influential patrician clan; has produced illustrious statesmen, writers, educators, political lead...
Insignia/Crest: Laurel wreath and ceremonial Haora weave.

Part II: Extended Lineages, Village Governance & Longshim Institution

Hereditary chieftainship (Awunga), elders council (Hangva), and youth dormitories:

ADDITIONAL PATRILINEAL LINEAGES:

*** Ruivah [Somdal, Western Tangkhul (Remva), Phadang]**
Historic Role: Eminent lineage renowned for scholarship, customary law codification, pioneering education, and village a...

*** Shingnaisui [Hunphun, Lunghar, Sihai]**
Historic Role: Ancient clan renowned for religious integrity, peace pacts (Phaikham), and inter-village diplomatic embas...

*** Sareo [Eastern and Southern ranges (Kamo, Somra)]**
Historic Role: Respected lineage renowned for agricultural terrace mastery, hunting rites, and communal stewardship....

*** A'Shao (AS) [Hunphun ancestral village site]**
Historic Role: Foundational clan lineage with deep genealogical roots; custodians of original settlement lore and villag...

*** Other Prominent Lineages [Widespread across all Tangkhul valleys]**
Historic Role: Includes Kashung, Phungshok, Raleng, Kengoo, Mahongnao, Kaping, Muivah, Khangrah, Rungsung, Hongray, Chah...

VILLAGE GOVERNANCE INSTITUTIONS:

>> Awunga (Hereditary Village King / Chief)
Jurisdiction: Supreme titular head of the village sovereign territory.
Powers & Functions: Inaugurates annual festivals (Luira sod-turning); leads war defense in ancient times; acts as chief ...

>> Hangva (Council of Village Clan Elders)
Jurisdiction: The supreme legislative, judicial, and executive assembly of the village.
Powers & Functions: Composed of representative heads of each patrilineal clan (Shang); deliberates on property disputes,...

>> Pikha / Khunbu (Sacred Priest & Land Custodian)
Jurisdiction: Spiritual rites and ancient sacrificial custody.
Powers & Functions: Descendant of the foundational village settler; performs invocations at sacred groves; sanctifies bo...

>> Yarnao (Peer-Group Labor Cooperatives)
Jurisdiction: Youth and adult mutual-aid agricultural teams.
Powers & Functions: Rotates intensive labor across member terraced paddy fields during planting, weeding, and harvesting...

>> Longshim (Youth Dormitory Institution)
Jurisdiction: Central educational, military, and cultural institution.
Powers & Functions: Divided into Mayarshim (boys dormitory) and Ngashim (girls dormitory). Served as indigenous universi...